

62 Interrupted actions

English often uses the past continuous and the past simple together to tell stories, especially when one event interrupts another.

New language Past continuous and past simple

Aa Vocabulary Travel and leisure

New skill Describing interrupted actions

62.1 KEY LANGUAGE PAST CONTINUOUS AND PAST SIMPLE

When English uses the past continuous and past simple together, the past continuous describes a longer, background action, and the past simple describes a shorter action that interrupts the background action.

LONGER BACKGROUND ACTION

SHORTER MAIN ACTION

I **was taking** a photo when **a monkey grabbed** my camera.



62.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES PAST CONTINUOUS AND PAST SIMPLE

He **was sunbathing** when **it started** to rain.

She **was sleeping** when **the phone rang**.



62.3 LISTEN TO THE AUDIO AND MARK WHICH TENSE DESCRIBES THE ACTIVITY IN EACH PICTURE

